

# Marktplaats holds the supply. The buyer's side of it is unmeasured. Ten observations, four comparison markets, and the inferences we draw.

**18.7M**

live listings, 350,000 added daily [1][5]

**73%**

of online reuse, self-reported by Marktplaats [5]

**1.2**

of 5 on Trustpilot, 4,379 self-selected reviews [9]

**61%**

of Dutch consumers bought used in the past year [18]

**7%**

were victims of purchase fraud in 2024, CBS [16]

**€6.95**

to €10.95 a month, charged today for listing alerts [21]

## Ten observations. Recorded from public sources. Company-reported and review-site figures are labelled, because neither is a representative sample.

### Search matches keywords, not descriptions

It needs the Dutch noun a Dutch seller typed. Attributes are optional, so dimensions and included parts cannot be filtered. Marktplaats publishes rules against keyword stuffing, which implies it is common. [15]

### No price history is exposed to buyers

Unlike eBay, nothing shows what comparable items sold for. Auction listings also show an opening bid in the price position, so prices are not comparable across listings.

### Complaints cluster on trust and support

Fraudulent listings staying live after reports, protection charged either way, no route to a human, bans shortly after registration. Self-selected sample. [9][10][11]

### Purchase fraud is the most common online fraud

CBS: 7% of people 15+ in 2024, up from 5.6% in 2022, ahead of sales fraud at 1.5%. Not attributed to any platform. [16]

### Three Dutch services already sell alert speed

MarktAlert publishes €6.95 and €10.95 tiers. MPAlerts is described as filtering listings with a model, though its site refused our request. [21][22][23]

### UK: share moved fast between platforms

Reporting on CMA analysis puts Vinted at 50 to 60% of UK C2C apparel volume in 2025, against 5 to 10% in 2021, with eBay falling to 10 to 20%. [25]

### Germany: same complaints, plus forced rails

Kleinanzeigen is reported at about 35M monthly users. Reviewers describe being pushed onto its own shipping and reading its buyer protection as a fee. [30][31]

### Russia: funds held, goods moved

Avito holds the buyer's money until the item is confirmed and refunds return postage. One trade source reports an assistant for all users in 2026, which we could not corroborate. [36][38]

### China: trust is operational, engagement is social

Zhuanzhuan inspects items in custody with over 2,000 staff. Xianyu reports 209M monthly actives organised around 1.3M interest groups. Both company-derived. [39][42]

### USA: live auctions grew, on company numbers

Whatnot reports over \$8B volume in 2025, doubling. A second source says \$6B for the same year. Conversion claims come from the industry, not from an independent test. [33][34]

## Three of twenty five jobs, proposed for focus. Each rests on a named inference, and each says what would remove it from the list.

Jobs 1, 2, 3, 9

### State constraints, see only what meets them

Rests on the inference that the limitation is structural, not a ranking problem. Drops if interviews show buyers mostly search for named products rather than described objects.

Jobs 7, 8

### A search that keeps running and reports back

The only candidate with external evidence that people in this market pay for it. Drops if measured match quality stays low, since then there is nothing worth notifying about.

Jobs 5, 17

### How this price compares with comparable items

Our own observed listings are the only available comparable set, and disappearance is a weak proxy for a sale. Drops if the proxy proves too noisy to state a verdict.

Six of twenty hypotheses. Thresholds are judgement calls chosen to be decidable in weeks at our traffic, not benchmarks.

| Prediction                                     | Measurement                                                                                                     | Falsified if                                   |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| The stated reason raises listing views         | Click-through with the reason line shown against hidden                                                         | No positive difference                         |
| Disclosing hidden listings does not cost trust | 7 day return rate by arm, with grouped reasons shown                                                            | The disclosure arm returns less                |
| A saved search creates repeat use              | Creation rate at the offer point, 7 day return by cohort                                                        | Creation under 10%                             |
| Some users pay for a saved search              | Paid conversion among users with an active search                                                               | Conversion under 2%                            |
| A price comparison changes behaviour           | Seller contacts by arm, plus one direct question. Direction is uncertain: it should also prevent some purchases | It moves neither contacts nor stated decisions |
| Dutch long-tail pages attract search traffic   | Organic sessions and conversion from 200 constraint pages and 25 valuation pages, at day 90                     | Under about 1,000 sessions a month             |

Four weeks, three people. Primary metric: users with an active saved search who opened a result in the last seven days.

| Week                       | Designer                                                                                                | Engineer                                                                                                           | Marketing                                                                                              |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1<br>Measure first         | Five interviews, two with non-Dutch speakers, testing the two competing readings of the complaint data. | Event schema, then a 50 wish labelled set that reports precision, recall and cost per search. Fix what it exposes. | Keyword map: 200 constraint pages, 25 valuation pages. Community conversations opened by hand.         |
| 2<br>Saved searches        | Creation in one step. The notification itself, readable at a glance. A management list.                 | Storage and a 5 to 15 minute runner with caching, jitter and back-off, filtering only new listings.                | First 60 constraint pages and 10 valuation pages. Ten short videos from the daily finds.               |
| 3<br>Price and payment     | The verdict component with comparables on demand. The paid tier, price stated plainly.                  | Persist observed listings as the comparable set. A valuation that refuses to answer when data is thin.             | 25 valuation pages live. First organic reading. A €500 paid test measured on saved searches.           |
| 4<br>Reliability and reach | Fix the two largest drop-offs. Landing page using a real search. Record the design tokens.              | Alerting on failed runs and model fallbacks. Quiet risk flags. 2dehands as a second source.                        | Press outreach measured on 30 day retention. Referral on shared snapshots. One page review by channel. |

250

retained users with a saved search, day 30

1,000

saved searches created

40

paying users, the smallest sample that decides it

85%

precision on the internal set, 80% recall

8 min

median delay from listing to alert

5

interviews a week, recorded

Sources. [1] Marktplaats.nl, Wikipedia. [5] The Marktplaats Effect, Marktplaats with Vaayu, 2023 data, company-reported. [9] Trustpilot, accessed 15 Sep 2026, self-selected sample. [10] AVROTROS Radar forum. [11] Google Play and App Store reviews. [15] Marktplaats help, rules on keywords in advertisements. [16] CBS, Online veiligheid en criminaliteit 2024. [18] Consumentenonderzoek Potentie Tweedehands Spullen 2025, via Circulair Ambachtscentrum. [21][22][23] MarktAlert, a competitor; MPAlerts, which returned HTTP 403; Marktplaats Scanner. [25] CMA analysis of UK C2C apparel, via Value Added Resource. [30][31] Kleinanzeigen on Trustpilot; Coraly GPPI, where revenue is a third party estimate. [33][34] Whatnot via Ebrun and Ringing the Bell, whose figures conflict. [36][38] Ship24 and TAdviser; www1.ru, a single source. [39][42] ChinaTalk; Baidu Baike, company-derived. The full source list, with quality labels, is in the long version.